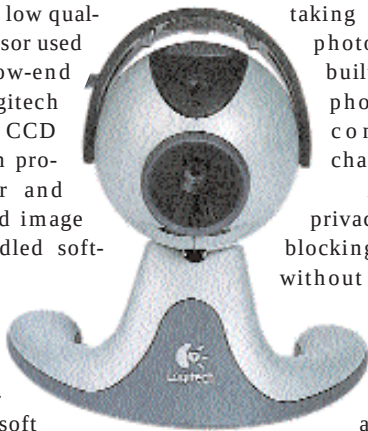


Logitech QuickCam Pro 3000

Better than the Rest

The QuickCam Pro is not just another Web cam. Instead of the low quality CMOS sensor used in other low-end cameras, Logitech has used a CCD sensor, which produces crisper and more detailed image quality. Bundled software includes Digital Radar II video monitoring software, Microsoft NetMeeting, Reality Fusion GameCam SE, CrestaCards Video greeting software, MGI PhotoSuite III SE, and the MGI VideoWave III SE for performing various tasks such as Web casting, motion detection, still photography, etc.

Price: Rs 9,000
Contact: Logitech
Phone: 022-6427501
E-mail: crescent_fernandes@logitech.com
Web site: www.logitech.com



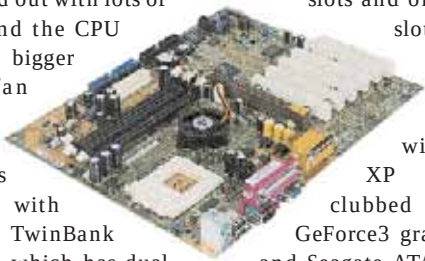
The camera has an onboard shutter button for taking still digital photographs and a built-in microphone for video conferencing/chatting. Also, it has a privacy cover for blocking broadcasts without switching off the camera, and a SmartClip for laptops and flat panel monitors. The price is a little high but if you consider its bundled software and free services, this camera is worth it.

Logitech Quickcam		B+
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Features	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
OVERALL	★★★★	

ASUS A7N266-E

Good for Work and Play

A7N266-E is the nVidia nForce420 chipset based solution from ASUS. The board is neatly laid out with lots of space around the CPU socket for bigger heatsink/fan combinations. The board is equipped with nVidia's TwinBank technology, which has dual channel support for DDR SDRAM. The board is first in the market to sport Dolby 5.1 audio and S/PDIF IN/OUT connectivity. This audio support is integrated into the nVidia MCP-D south bridge chip. Also, the ASUS ACR module is



provided with the board to get Dolby 5.1 working out of the box. The board has six PCI slots and one AGP Pro slot. The board was tested with Athlon XP 2000+ clubbed with a GeForce3 graphics card and Seagate ATA100 7200-rpm hard drive. It gave good overall results in all the tests. This board also features the TwinBank technology, which is basically a dual channel DDR solution. It is enabled only when you occupy the third DIMM slot along with

another. When the TwinBank feature is used, the effective theoretical memory bandwidth doubles. In Business Winstone 2001 it gave an impressive 60.6 marks whereas in Content Creation 2001 it managed 84.5. In the *Quake III* test also, the board was able to reach a high score of 162.7 fps in max mode and 316.2 fps in normal mode. This qualifies it for the serious office user and the gaming community as well. The board came complete with a detailed manual, soft-

Price: Rs 14,950
Contact: Zeta Technologies
Phone: 022-4102288
E-mail: sales@zetaindia.com
Web site: www.zetaindia.com

ware CD, Messiah and *Star Trek: New World* game CD. This motherboard is a good choice for those looking for pure performance, with no budgetary constraints.

ASUS A7N266-E		A-
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Features	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
OVERALL	★★★★	

CrazyTalk Standard Edition 2.51

Sets Tongues Wagging!

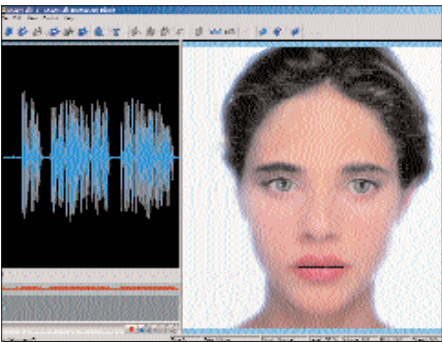
CrazyTalk can make a plain looking image talk. This utility can add voice and animation to an image without any additional hardware. You can also generate outputs of presentable quality with natural or synthetic voices and different emotions.

CrazyTalk has built-in 2D models such as a man, woman, robot, etc to choose from. The software did a good job with our test image. It not only moved the eyes and lips while talking but even the jaw, which made it look very real!

Price: \$39.95 (approx 1,957)
Web site: www.reallusion.com

Here you can use your own image instead of the built-in images. The configuration of images is a bit tricky—if not done properly you might end up with a completely distorted image. The text to speech feature, however, needs a lot of improvement, as there was some amount of skipping with words such as 'technical', but most simple words were spoken well.

The utility is available for \$39.95 (approximately Rs 1,957) and is a great tool for presentations and even for reading back text.



CrazyTalk SE 2.51		B+
Performance	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Ease of use	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Value for Money	★★★★	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★	